LCOY
NEPAL 2026

"Together for Climate Transparency"

NATIONAL CHILDREN & YOUTH STATEMENT 2026



Prepared By
Nepalese Youth for Climate Action (NYCA)
Youth Action for Sustainable and Eco Nepal (YASEN)

NYCA

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National Children and Youth Statement on Climate Change

Local Conference of Youth (LCOY) Nepal 2026

Nepalese Youth for Climate Action (NYCA) &

Youth Action for Sustainable and Eco Nepal (YASEN)

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Above all, this statement belongs wholly to the young people of Nepal. We thank the 177 delegates who travelled from all seven provinces to join us in Kathmandu from 14th to 16th August 2026, and whose testimonies, province-wise case studies, and consensus gave this document its substance and its honesty. We thank all the 116 respondents to the *"Every Voice Counts"* online survey and the more than 1,500 young people who took part in the pre-event virtual consultations, whose willingness to speak openly about climate impacts, loss and damage, and exclusion from decision-making laid the foundation for everything that has followed. And, we thank the many unseen hands behind these pages: the session facilitators and session leads, rapporteurs, and translators who carried voices across local languages, the speakers, resource persons, and mentors, and the logistics and hospitality volunteers, together with the families and communities who sustained every part of the journey along the way.

To every contributor whose name does not appear here but whose effort is woven throughout this statement, we thank you all. This document is a mirror of our shared reality and a mandate for climate action and our sustainable future.

- ***The LCOY Nepal 2026 Organizing Team***

Executive Summary

Nepal ranks among the most climate-vulnerable countries despite having minimal contribution to global emissions. Our country faces a warming trend of 0.56°C per decade, with warming in the Himalayas reaching up to 0.6°C per decade, accelerating glacier retreat, with 21 glacial lakes now classified as potentially dangerous paired with the uncertainties of erratic monsoons, and intensifying disasters. The recent September 2024 floods in Kathmandu exceeded 2.5 times the bank-full extent, causing significant damages, and the devastating Bhotekoshi-Trishuli flash flood in Rasuwa, Nuwakot and Dhading districts on 26th August 2026 only makes this worse, with more than casualties of more than 1000 people, more than 5000 out of contact and an unprecedented damage of property and livelihoods. Half of those killed or injured by climate hazards in the last five years are children and youth, yet their voices remain structurally excluded from the climate decision-making process.

This statement captures the voices of Nepal's children and youth on climate change, which is developed through a multi-phase consultation process. It is built on online inputs from 116 young people across all seven provinces and enriched by 170 delegates during the LCOY Nepal 2026 in-person event.

This statement is centered on seven interconnected themes and demands that reflect our lived experiences, urgency, and vision. At its heart is a call for children and young people to be recognized not just as those most affected, but as equal partners in shaping climate solutions in Nepal.

Methodology

This statement is grounded in a multi-phase, youth-led consultation process. The present document is built primarily from online and pre-event inputs; and has been finalized with main event deliberations.

Phase 1: Online Voice Collection:

An online survey entitled ***"Every Voice Counts: LCOY Nepal 2026 Youth Voice Collection"*** was open from 21st – 31st July 2026, receiving 116 responses from all seven provinces. It captured youth perspectives on climate impacts, barriers to participation, loss and damage, WASH, agriculture, education, and inclusive climate action.

Phase 2: Pre-Event Virtual Consultations:

Virtual consultations engaged more than 1500 youths beyond the online survey, providing space for deeper thematic discussion and preliminary policy demand deliberation.

Phase 3: Main Event Deliberations (14th - 16th August 2026):

The three-day residential conference brought together youth delegates from all seven provinces of Nepal. The delegates reviewed and validated the draft, participated in thematic breakout sessions, presented province-wise case studies, and collectively refined and adopted the final statement through a dedicated finalization session. This phase ensures the statement reflects voices excluded from digital spaces, i.e. youth from remote areas, marginalized communities, and those with limited internet access.

Phase 4: Synthesis and Finalization:

All inputs across phases have been consolidated into the final statement, preserving participants' original testimonies, resolving divergences through youth-led deliberation, and ensuring the final statement represents the consensus-based position of LCOY Nepal 2026 delegates and all the children and youths of Nepal.

Alignment with International Frameworks

- **Paris Agreement (2015), Preamble:** Recognizes that climate action must respect, promote and consider obligations on human rights, including *"as well as gender equality, empowerment of women and intergenerational equity"*; and further recognizes *"the importance of the engagement of all levels of government and various actors"* in addressing climate change.
- **Glasgow Climate Pact (COP26, Decision -/CMA.3), Paragraph 64:** *"Urges Parties and stakeholders to ensure meaningful youth participation and representation in multilateral, national and local decision-making processes.*
- **Sharm el-Sheikh Implementation Plan (COP27, Decision 1/CP.27), Paragraph 55:** *"Recognizes the role of children and youth as agents of change in addressing and responding to climate change and encourages Parties to include children and youth in their processes for designing and implementing climate policy and action."*
- **ACE Action Plan (COP27, Decisions 23/CP.27 and 22/CMA.4):** Adopts a four-year Action Plan under Action for Climate Empowerment, aimed at **empowering all members of society, including children and youth**, to engage in climate action.
- **Presidency Youth Climate Champion (COP28, Decision 21/CMA.5):** The COP28 Presidency established the Youth Climate Champion role, and through its dedicated decision *(Decision 21/CMA.5, "Presidency youth climate champion," adopted at COP28, Dubai, 2023)* institutionalized the role within the UNFCCC process, requesting all future COP Presidencies to appoint a Youth Climate Champion.
- **UN Convention on the Rights of the Child (1989), Article 12:** Guarantees **the right of the child to express their views freely in all matters affecting them**, with those views given due weight in accordance with the age and maturity of the child.

Our Urgent Calls to Action

1. Youth & Children Engagement in Climate Processes:

Children and Youth across Nepal consistently report that their participation in climate governance is limited to token consultation at the utmost. While many have participated in awareness programs and community-level activities, very few have been included in actual policy discussions or decision-making. LCOY Nepal 2026 primarily identified six major structural barriers: lack of awareness and information regarding climate processes, inaccessible information and most of the information available in technical language and English, no dedicated youth-friendly platforms, geographic exclusion from the major policy discussions held in distant cities, insufficient funding for youth-led initiatives centered around climate action, and tokenism.

"Local decision-making spaces like ward or municipality consultations rarely reach out to students or young people directly. There's also a general assumption that climate policy is an adult or expert-only issue, and we children and youth are always excluded from the process.": Bidhan Pokhrel, 22, Gandaki

"Climate policy discussions happen in distant cities, completely cutting off remote border villages. Official climate laws are written in highly technical language, creating a massive barrier for youth who speak native mother tongues like Maithili or Bhojpuri.": Narendra Yadav, 20, Madhesh

Therefore, to address the above-mentioned challenges,

- We demand to legally mandate children and youth representation in all climate decision-making bodies at local, provincial, and federal levels as voting members with proportionate representation.
- We demand the government establish at least two Climate Champions in each of Nepal's 753 local levels, selected through a transparent and inclusive process, to utilize available local resources and locally lead climate action. This will strengthen a bottom-up approach to climate governance and ensure that children and youth are meaningfully engaged in climate action at the local level.

- We stress the need for plain-language, district-specific versions of every national climate plan and institutionalized language justice by translating all environmental policies, weather alerts, and grant guidelines into local languages.
- We strongly encourage the government and concerned stakeholders to create a formal feedback loop centered around children and youths, so that their recommendations receive documented government responses.

2. Loss & Damage, Climate Finance and Just Transition:

Communities across all provinces of Nepal report repeated, uncompensated losses, such as crop failures, infrastructure destruction, displacement, and water source depletion. Most respondents report their communities have not received any direct climate finance or compensation, and most of the finance never reels out a tangible outcome. Even where disaster relief exists, it is delayed, insufficient, exclusionary (particularly for those without land titles or formal identity documents), and reactive rather than proactive. Communities relying on practices with adverse effects on the environment do so out of economic necessity, not choice. A just transition must provide viable alternatives before removing the currently available income sources, protect vulnerable livelihoods during the shift, ensure community participation in planning, create green job opportunities, and decouple climate relief from land ownership.

"My house was swept away by a landslide and our crop was destroyed by heavy rainfall. But we didn't receive any help or compensation for that": Samir Ale Magar, 24, Bagmati

"No financial support is provided to anyone from our community who faced climate-induced hazards, by any authority and stakeholders.": Jeena Yadav, 20, Bagmati

"A fair transition would mean farmers getting real support to shift to sustainable methods... training in organic or climate-resilient farming, access to affordable eco-friendly alternatives... It should be a gradual, supported change.": Bidhan Pokhrel, 22, Gandaki

For the above issues, our demands are:

- We insist on establishing a dedicated, legally binding "Climate Resilience Programme" for the most vulnerable indigenous and farming communities especially in rural Nepal; with a mandate for localized climate-adaptation budgets and provision of a need based insurance, managed by ward committees with inclusion of children, youth, women, and marginalized groups.
- We call for immediate and decisive action to develop a comprehensive National Just Transition Framework that ensures no worker, community, or marginalized group is left behind as Nepal moves toward a net zero carbon, climate-resilient future.
- We call upon the government to ensure that climate financing is supported by public and private sectors, including corporate sectors' focus on environmental responsibilities, and is equally accessible to the impacted people at grassroots level, including those without land titles or formal identity documents.
- We emphasize the importance of delivering localized weather alerts and early warning information via media devices in local languages, recognizing that timely, accessible, and culturally appropriate climate information is not a privilege but a fundamental right of every citizen, particularly those in remote, rural, and indigenous communities who face the greatest climate risks.
- We recognize the urgency to advocate for enhanced Fund Responding to Loss and Damage (FRLD) which is smoothly accessible to the Least Developed countries and highly vulnerable mountain communities, at COP 31.

3. Changing Mountains and Livelihoods:

Nepal's mountain ecosystems are undergoing rapid transformation, like declining snow cover and glacial retreat with 21 glacial lakes classified as potentially dangerous (ICIMOD 2020), with drying springs and rivers forcing women and girls to walk longer distances, continuously shifting forest lines altering biodiversity, and unpredictable weather rendering our traditional knowledge

unreliable. The changing mountain environment is directly undermining our mountain livelihoods. Farming is becoming unreliable, yak herding is collapsing, tourism is threatened, and young people are migrating from mountain communities, further weakening traditional knowledge systems.

"The snow cover on Machhapuchhre has significantly decreased over the years. Now, it looks like a 'Kala Patthar'. Across many regions of Gandaki Province, glacier melting and glacier lake outburst events have become growing concerns." Alina B.K., 22, Gandaki

Our demands include:

- We urge the government to priorities the agenda of mountain communities in all national climate policies and international negotiations, especially strengthening cooperation on transboundary rivers and glaciers, all while ensuring mountain voices lead the discussions that shape their future.
- We demand the protection and restoration of mountain water sources through conservation and community-led watershed management, especially prioritising springs and glacial-fed streams, all while sustaining the millions of livelihoods that depend on them downstream.
- We demand full recognition and protection of indigenous knowledge as a resource for climate adaptation, placing special focus on the wisdom of local and indigenous communities, and ensuring this knowledge is safeguarded from erosion or exploitation.
- We demand special attention be made for adaptation efforts towards high altitude glacier systems, including special efforts for GLOFs, and accelerated glacial melts.

4. Agriculture, Food Security and Nutrition:

Agriculture, the primary livelihood for the majority of Nepalis, is becoming increasingly unreliable due to erratic rainfall, extreme heat, pest outbreaks, water scarcity, soil degradation and many such problems. Despite the shift towards chemical-intensive agriculture promoted by green revolution, many communities still maintain traditional practices that support climate adaptation, like mixed cropping, farmyard manure and compost, traditional seed varieties (indigenous landraces),

rainwater harvesting, crop rotation, agroforestry, and traditional village ponds (pokharis) that store monsoon overflow and recharge groundwater.

"Our elders still rely on traditional practices like crop diversification, village ponds (pokharis) that recharge groundwater, organic mulching, and indigenous seed landraces adapted to survive long local droughts.": Narendra Yadav, 20, Madhesh

And thus,

- We urge the government to Invest in climate-smart agriculture at scale, especially prioritizing smallholder farmers and establish local seed banks all while preserving indigenous genetic diversity.
- We call upon the government bodies to develop an integrated marketing framework for farmers helping them to fetch fair prices of their produce by reducing significant post-harvest losses, and subsequently provide simplified crop insurance with local level legal help desks.
- We call for immediate action to subsidize the transition to organic farming through targeted support for smallholder farmers, and formally integrate traditional and indigenous knowledge into national agricultural policy by shifting our focus from consumptive use towards productive use, because we believe a just agricultural transition must look both forward to innovation and backward to the ancestral wisdom we cannot afford to lose.
- We urge the government to leverage modern technologies to strengthen traditional agricultural practices and build climate-smart circular agriculture systems that respond to the changing weather patterns, with emphasis on regenerative and precision agriculture.
- We emphasize the importance of supporting mountain livelihoods through climate-resilient agriculture, sustainable pastoral practices, and eco-tourism, because those who call the Himalayas their home, must have the resources and opportunities to thrive in a changing climate, not just merely survive it.

5. WASH and Water Security:

Every province in Nepal reports intensifying water-related challenges: drying springs and declining groundwater, contamination after floods, seasonal water scarcity, inadequate water infrastructure, and sanitation failures during climate events. Post-disaster, communities rely on a patchwork of solutions, be it boiling or filtering water, purchasing bottled water, and rely heavily on emergency distribution that are often insufficient, delayed, and uncoordinated.

"In Kathmandu, groundwater levels are declining rapidly due to overextraction and excessive concretization. The Bishnumati River is heavily contaminated with untreated sewage and solid waste.": Bishwadeep Paudel, 24, Bagmati

"During prolonged dry periods, many natural springs produce less water, making it difficult for for households and farmers in our region to access safe drinking water and irrigation.": Geeban Giri, 30, Karnali

To stop these incidents from happening any further,

- We urge the government to build inclusive, climate-resilient drinking water systems backed by scientific research, with protected sources and flood-resistant pipelines, and a particular emphasis on improving drainage and sanitation infrastructure, while also ensuring that local level emergency water supply plans are in place.
- We demand the establishment of water levels and quality monitoring systems during pre and post monsoon seasons, while emphasizing improving the drainage and sanitation infrastructure, ensuring this information is disseminated to the community on time.
- We call upon the government bodies to expand irrigation and drinking water infrastructure, prioritizing solar-power, lift irrigation, drip irrigation, and ensure water security for both consumption and food security systems.

6. Climate Resilient Education System and ACE:

Climate education in Nepal's schools and colleges remains largely inadequate. It has minimal coverage on important topics, theoretical focus rather than practical real-life experiences, no green skills training, added with school infrastructure which are not resilient to climate induced hazards. We need education that is practical and interdisciplinary, connecting climate science with policy, law, engineering, agriculture, and community engagement, with green skills training, innovation opportunities, and a proper institutional backing.

"I'd like to see climate change taught as a proper subject, not just a short chapter, along with practical green skills like renewable energy basics, organic farming, waste management, and water conservation.": Kanchan Shrestha, 18, Bagmati

"I would like to see our college introduce Climate Litigation and Environmental Law Clinics... to teach us how to use public interest litigation to hold polluters accountable and help border communities claim government compensation.": Narendra Yadav, 20, Madhesh

In accordance to this,

- We demand the government to integrate comprehensive climate education into the national curriculum at all levels into all core subjects, while mandating practical green skills training including sustainable agriculture, waste management, renewable energy, GIS, green entrepreneurship, and green seed funds.
- We firmly assert the investment in climate-resilient school infrastructure with a focus on establishing eco-clubs and climate action programs in every school and college backed by institutional funding.
- We urge the government to support youth-led research and innovative citizen science approaches primarily by creating climate education materials in local languages and accessible formats, while ensuring data and information remain accessible to everyone.

7. Gender Equality, Disability and Social Inclusion (GEDSI):

Climate change does not affect everyone equally. Women and girls bear increased workload collecting water and fuel, face safety risks, and experience health impacts including disrupted menstrual cycles, all because of some unprecedented climate-induced disasters. Marginalized communities like Dalits are often forced to settle on climate-vulnerable terrain and face discrimination in accessing relief. Indigenous peoples lose traditional livelihoods tied to specific ecosystems and face exclusion from decision-making processes, involving the resources and practices they have been owning from so long. Madhesi communities face extreme heat and crop failure compounded by linguistic barriers. Persons with disabilities face inaccessible evacuation routes, shelters, early warning systems, and relief services. LGBTQIA+ individuals face social discrimination limiting access to climate information and social participation. Systemic barriers are preventing inclusive participation, which include lack of awareness and information access, financial constraints, social discrimination, language barriers, inaccessible infrastructure, no reserved seats for marginalized groups in climate discussions, and identity documentation barriers.

"Women often travel longer distances to collect water during droughts, increasing their workload and safety risks. Persons with disabilities face greater challenges during floods because evacuation routes, shelters, and early warning systems are often not accessible.": Man Singh Bist, 26, Sudurpaschhim

"The biggest barrier preventing marginalized groups in our border area, like Dalits, landless farmers, and women, is systemic socio-economic exclusion. Because these groups rarely own land, they are routinely left out of local agricultural cooperatives and ward committees where climate adaptation funds are distributed.": Narendra Yadav, 20, Madhesh

With a growing concern towards this issue,

- We demand mandatory reserved seats for women, children, Dalits, Madhesi, Indigenous peoples, persons with disabilities, marginalized communities, ethnic minorities and LGBTQIA+ individuals in all climate and disaster management committees, ensuring their voices directly shape the decisions that affect them.

- We insist that all climate policies and budgets be inclusive and community-led, decoupling climate relief from land ownership, ensuring no one is excluded from support based on what they own.
- We urge the government to prioritize children and youth well-being, mental health and SRHR in the face of climate change and climate anxiety amongst young people.
- We demand gender-responsive policies that address the disproportionate impacts of climate change on children, women, gender minorities and vulnerable communities, paired with investment in climate-resilient livelihoods accessible to persons with disabilities and marginalized communities.

Youth Commitment

Transforming our future requires shared responsibility and intergenerational action. Therefore, as the future changemakers of Nepal, we pledge to:

1. **Actively engage** in national and international climate processes, including the implementation of NDC 3.0, COP negotiations, and local adaptation planning, ensuring that the voices of youth, children, marginalized groups, and frontline communities are fully represented in climate related decision-making throughout.
2. **Lead youth-driven climate initiatives**, integrating science, technology, and traditional knowledge to achieve measurable outcomes in mitigation, adaptation, biodiversity protection, and climate-resilient livelihoods.
3. **Strengthen climate literacy, green skills, and advocacy capacities** among peers, build collaborative networks, and promote intergenerational equity, enabling youth across Nepal to participate meaningfully in climate governance and community resilience initiatives.
4. **Track implementation** of national climate policies and youth-led initiatives, evaluate outcomes, and report publicly. Hold governments, institutions, and corporations accountable for climate commitments, promoting transparency, inclusivity, and equitable access to resources while reinforcing the role of youth as active agents in sustainable development.
5. **Serve as Climate Champions** in our communities, by raising awareness, engaging local governments, supporting implementation of local climate actions, and contributing to Nepal's NDC 3.0 commitments, ensuring that LCOY Nepal 2026 is not just an event but the beginning of a sustained, locally-led climate action.

Conclusion

This statement is a mandate drawn from the lived experiences of young people across all seven provinces of Nepal via online consultations, pre-event virtual sessions, and the main LCOY conference deliberations. This statement is built on online responses and pre-event virtual sessions' inputs and further enriched by 177 delegates at the in-person event, ensuring digitally excluded voices are also reflected directly into our statement.

We call on the Government of Nepal and all stakeholders to:

Read this statement as a policy mandate;
Respond with documented responses to each recommendation;
Fund dedicated climate finance for youth-led and community-based adaptation; and
Implement by incorporating recommendations into the upcoming National Climate Change Policy review, NDC 3.0, and all relevant planning processes.

"Climate change is not waiting, and neither are we."

Annexes

Annex A: Demographic Profile (Phase 1: Online Respondents)

Total Respondents	**116**
Provinces	Bagmati (34), Madhesh (24), Gandaki (16), Lumbini (16), Koshi (11), Karnali (10), Sudurpaschhim (5)
Gender	Female 64 (55%), Male 52 (45%)
Community Identities	Khas Arya (48), Madhesi (16), Adivasi Janajati (15), None of the Above (13), Dalit (7), LGBTQIA+ (2), Person with Disabilities (2), Other (5)
Age Range	18 – 31 years
Consent for Attribution	91 named uses; 21 anonymous; 4 declined

Annex B: Thematic Focus (Online Respondents, multiple selections permitted)

Youth & Children Engagement in Climate Processes	86
WASH and Water Security	54
GEDSI	53
Agriculture, Food Security and Nutrition	50
Climate Resilient Education System and ACE	42
Loss & Damage, Climate Finance and Just Transition	37
Changing Mountains and Livelihoods	23
Total Youth Engaged (across all phases)	2000+

Annex C: LCOY Nepal 2026 Conference Details

Dates: 14-16 August 2026

Location: Kathmandu, Nepal

Participants: 177 youth from all seven provinces of Nepal

Organizers: Nepalese Youth for Climate Action (NYCA) & Youth Action for Sustainable and Eco Nepal (YASEN)

Endorsement: YOUNGO, the Official Children and Youth Constituency of the UNFCCC

Theme: *"Together for Climate Transparency"*

Annex D: Demographic Profile (Phase 2: In-person event participants)

Total Participants	**177**
Provinces	Koshi (23), Madhesh (22), Bagmati (65), Gandaki (27), Lumbini (9), Karnali (14), Sudurpaschhim (17)
Gender	Female:104 (58.75%), Male:71 (40.11%) LGBTQIA+: 2 (1.14%)
Community Identities	Khas Arya (117), Adivasi Janajati (26), Madhesi (16), Muslim (13), Dalit (9), LGBTQIA+ (2), Person with Disabilities (5), Other (7)
Age Range	18 – 35 years

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